



...FALLS SHORT

By Manish "Trigger-Happy" Rajesh
feedback@skoar.in

As Dusk Falls is an interactive drama and debut game from studio INTERIOR/NIGHT. At a glance, this is a choose your own adventure game, in a similar vein to Telltale games wherein you're prompted with dialogue and action choices as the game plays out. What we've got here is a midwestern crime thriller soap, which hopes to deliver a memorable story and characters. Does it succeed? Read on to find out.

Story

Dusk Fall's story spans three decades, and is centred around two families whose fates are tied together after a robbery goes wrong.

We'll try to keep spoilers to a minimum especially since the story is what you'll primarily be playing this game for. As Dusk Falls is set in Two Rock, Arizona. In the very first chap-

ter, you're introduced to the two families the story revolves around. The first chapter lays down the foundation of the rest of the story, and sets up how the two families will collide. As Dusk Falls does this by actively shifting between perspectives. You see the story unfold from the eyes of both families, and as more characters come in, more is revealed about them. Think of these as flashbacks. In most cases this works out pretty well, and allows you to look at things from someone else's perspective; why they're doing what they're doing, what makes them tick, and how they ended up in this situation. However, there are times where it doesn't work out as well. These moments just distract you from the main story with what seems like a pointless side plot that feels unrewarding and unnecessary. Like we mentioned in the intro, the

plot attempts to set itself up to be this dark and twisted crime thriller, and before it was released, the story was even compared to the likes of Breaking Bad. However, at no point does As Dusk Falls ever come close in terms of calibre. While the characters suffice for the purposes of driving forward the game's plot, they otherwise are lacking in any kind of depth. You can pretty much immediately tell what kind of person a character is the moment they enter the scene. It's trope central.

The game consists of six chapters, which should take you about an hour each to finish. At the end of each chapter you're given a rundown based on the decisions you made. These are basically meant to be an assessment of you as a character. Were you honest? Did you care for the safety of your family? Etc. If you're a completionist or enjoyed the story (it's not com-